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Pete Candoli

Pete Candoli was born in Mishawaka, Indiana on June 28, 1923. His father encouraged him in his musical aspirations and he was playing trumpet with major swing bands while still in his teens. His skill as a lead player and jazz soloist made him a sought-after sideman and he toured and recorded with a long list of ensembles, including Woody Herman, Charlie Barnet, Tommy Dorsey and Glenn Miller. Pete has been equally successful in small groups, often collaborating with his brother Conte. He has performed on some 5000 record dates and is also noted as an arranger and composer. Pete was honored by Look *and* Esquire *magazines as one of the seven all-time outstanding trumpet players. He continues to perform and record and also finds time to conduct workshops at colleges across the country.*

Pete was interviewed in Los Angeles on February 15, 1999, by Monk Rowe, Director of the Fillius Jazz Archive.

MR: We are filming in Los Angeles for the Hamilton College Jazz Archive. My name is Monk Rowe and it's a great pleasure for me to have Pete Candoli with me. Welcome.

PC: Thank you, Monk, it's a pleasure to be here and a privilege. Thanks.

MR: I started counting the albums you've been on and I lost track at 1,335.

PC: I don't have, oddly enough I don't even have the old "Peter Gunn" things with Hank Mancini. That was twenty, forty, thirty years ago, something like that.

MR: It's just an amazing list, and along with the albums the people that you've been involved with musically. It's quite impressive.

PC: Really, I've been so fortunate. I think most musicians, I would do it whether it was worthwhile or if I was starving, the same thing. You do it because you love music. And so it's been a real privilege as I remember my father, our father, you punch a clock early in the morning, you come home, and it's cold winters and everything, and he decided like Conte and I were going to be a little different than hanging around working in a factory, which is very commendable because they're wonderful people, really. And they were nice people. So we got both ends pretty well covered that way.

MR: He wanted something different for you?

PC: He decided we were going to be big time musicians. That's when the big bands were doing things like that. And I don't think my brother and I disappointed him at all.

MR: I guess not.

PC: No, we were very fortunate. In fact I think I am the youngest musician on record of joining the union. My father signed me in when I was 13 years old, the South Bend Local.

MR: And he got to see some of your really good success.

PC: Oh yeah.

MR: How long did he live?

PC: He lived until after '61.

MR: Oh great, so he saw you with—

PC: He saw us both having some nice things and seeing us do what he had in mind all through. He was a wonderful guy. I remember I took Ziggy Elman's place, that was the Herd just before he went in the service, and I took his place with Tommy Dorsey's band, and Sy Oliver was writing for the band. And at the Hotel Sherman they changed the band every two weeks, another name band would come in. And he knew my father, and he would say, "Tony, did you bring some wine with you?" Because he loved my father's wine. My father had a wine cellar with bottles that, as I remember them, 25 years they'd been — and every time he went to Chicago he said, "Your Dad coming in, Pete?" I'd say, "Yeah." So it was quite something.

MR: You started on the French horn? Is that correct?

PC: Well yeah. I took that in orchestra. And to give you a go ahead, Conte and I, my brother is about four years younger than I am, and in our small town there was a very big Italian neighborhood. And they had a marching band and my father had all the instruments. He was self taught trumpet, and he had a bass drum, he had peck horns and things, and he'd pass them out to the neighbors and they'd play them, and every now and then we'd play Italian tunes and my ear, I think I was about four, five, or six, we'd walk along with the band peck horn [scats] and we knew the pulse was the important thing [scats] as if you're a percussion man. But we played by ear. And I remember those days. As a matter of fact, the first World's Fair was in Chicago, in the late 30s I think — I mean the late 20s and starting in the beginning in the 30s I think.

MR: Oh. 1929 wasn't it? The Chicago World's Fair.

PC: I think so. And the big thing about it was an Italian general by the name of Italo Balbo was bringing non-stop from Italy, a squadron of Italian Army planes, and they were tri-winged, three wings, and as it went over Mishawaka, which is about a hundred miles, right near where South Bend is, a hundred miles from Chicago, everybody was waving flags, and you'd see, here they are, and you'd hear these things. And I remember we started playing "The Fascista Song," which was the Mussolini type thing, it was the marching song. Of course then it was—

MR: It was okay.

PC: But I remember playing and playing the peck horn, and then looking up at these planes and everybody's cheering and saying well they can't hear us up there, can they?

MR: "Be quiet, just play."

PC: It was amazing. It was part of getting acquainted in music I guess. Like I played French horn, I played in the orchestra also, and I doubled in French horn and trumpet. I took trumpet because of my father, and for a while I played string bass in the school orchestra also. And I was privileged to go to state and national three times, and I won first all three times. So, you know it's a thing you do when you're in a school orchestra.

MR: Your ear must have been getting some really good training between the off-beats on the peck horn and the string bass.

PC: Yeah it was quite amazing. I remember coming into the eighth grade and I had a little 78 of "Patricia," and I'm trying to tell the music teacher, like we'd always march in the classrooms on Haydn [scats]. But I was really amazed. I said, "Don't you hear what's happening?" I would tell her, "Can't you hear these sounds?" I mean it killed me then. I was in the eighth grade. And so, "Well yes, that's very nice, Walter," that's my real name is Walter, see? And I said okay. It didn't give her a charge. And I just got a bigger charge when I heard my first Jimmy Lunceford record sound. And "Jitney Man" by — somebody on piano voted for me for the *Esquire* magazine award, which I was elected one year, and I can't think of his name.

MR: With Jimmy Lunceford?

PC: No, no, he wasn't with Jimmy Lunceford. He recorded a thing called the "Jitney Man" with a big band. He's a drummer originally. I'll think of it somewhere down the line.

MR: Not Chick Webb?

PC: Chick Webb. Isn't that amazing? I remember him and that, and I say — because very few people even knew who Chick Webb was, let alone get on the record. It was usually hotel bands, and a few oddballs that were playing for listeners. And then it dawned upon me all the hotel bands had a pattern, a sound. It was like a product. They were smart. Like Sammy Kaye had [scats] before the singer got up, and Horace Hite [scats] all the triple tonguing. And everybody had a thing. Tommy Dorsey even played the first sixteen of a ballad, a solo tone mute with clarinets in the background, the first sixteen.

MR: I see. So that they had a signature that you would recognize.

PC: Oh yeah, Guy Lombardo, you knew every time you put the needle down it was Guy Lombardo. It was amazing.

MR: That's cool.

PC: So that's the kind of bringing up—

MR: Were you anxious to get out of high school and get on with it?

PC: Yes, really. I remember in fact I went to Purdue, there was a guy by the name of Paul Reegy was one of the youngest men, in engineering, in the faculty at Purdue, I think he

was 27, and he was on the faculty. And he played piano. And he was into logarithms and all that. Figuratively speaking, you know, he had a college band. And first of all I used to ride my bicycle up to the high school, which was about a mile away on Lincoln Way, which is the big main drag from Mishawaka, every Friday we used to play for dances. And I played all the jazz. And I remember having my tux and rolling up my pants so it wouldn't get caught in the chain, and my trumpet, and getting down there I'd get off study hall early so I could make the 4:00 downbeat.

MR: That's great.

PC: And I played with all these — we had two ladies also, saxophonists, and it was called Jimmy Bach and his Eight Cylinders in Music. And that was a big deal. And they went on to Purdue, engineering. And while they were up there a couple of years I think they had a New Years Eve gig and they needed another trumpet player, a ride man, and they said well you ought to get Pete Candoli, he does all the things with Cylinders. So they said well could you get him? One of those. So one of the guys came back, drove back from Mishawaka, which was 80 miles from Purdue, the campus, and drove me up there and I stayed all night and it was a big deal, I think I was 14.

MR: Wow, stayed overnight.

PC: Yeah.

MR: And you're the ride man, right? You're the hot player.

PC: Yeah, I had such a great time really, it was just marvelous. And then of course they became my guardians and got permission from my folks. Like I lived with them, I was 15 and I graduated at 16, but I went right on and stayed there at Purdue because Paul Reegy had the orchestra, and so I remember the second year we had a gig for the whole summer at Sylvania, Ohio, right below Toledo, at a big open quarry. And the band was going to be there all summer and I think they were bringing in name bands every other week for a couple of nights a week. Like Charlie Spivak came through and Sonny Dunham came through one night, and Carlos Gastel was their manager. He was a big heavy guy who had Peggy Lee and Nat King Cole, and he was managing Sonny Dunham. And of course I got to pick up on all these bands at that time. I think we were getting eight dollars for the week, and a place to stay and a meal ticket at the local restaurant. And this was—

MR: This was, let's see, late 30s?

PC: Yeah. Before the war, just before the war. And then like I said Carlos Gastel at one time, this was two years after, to me he said, "Hey kid, you want to join the band?" There was somebody by the name of Cohen who was a New York trumpet player, but before that, at Purdue, Will Bradley and Ray McKinley came in for one night to play for a dance and I subbed for one of the trumpet players. He was sick or something. I played the whole

night and I remember Ray McKinley, who was a wonderful guy, a great drummer really, and he had the boogie woogie band, you know with Freddie Slack, and I finished the gig and I was really excited. And I overheard Ray McKinley say, "You know when that kid gets some experience he's going to be great." Just like that. And I heard and I was insulted. I said what does he mean? I'm going to be great — I said I can do anything Harry does, which I used to do all the technical things Harry did. I says I can imitate Roy Eldridge, and I can play anything. I said what does he mean by that? Well a few years later I knew exactly what he meant. Experience. You can't explain it, you've just got to get it and it will happen, really. It's something you do and live through. Playing with other musicians, listening to that, being influenced here, everything makes you what you are, or your make-up. You can have all the facilities in the world. I did. I could play anything I wanted. I was very natural. Music, trumpet came very easy for me. And these are the experiences I got when you wind up with the Charlie Barnets and then I played with Basie for a short time, and I did a picture with Duke Ellington's band, they hired me extra at Paramount for some picture for his band, and they hired me there to play with the band. And it's wonderful guys, really.

MR: Let me ask you about the first Herd, how that came about?

PC: Well I was with the band — Teddy Powell had a band. And it was very similar as the First Herd in style. On that band was Buddy DeFranco on clarinet, and there was Boots Mussulli, and Charlie Ventura was on the band, and different guys, George Handy was writing charts for the band, and Eddie Finkel, the composer was writing charts. And it was pretty outside in a sense. And I joined the band. I remember being with the band about three or four months, and I got a call from two attorneys by the name of Vellum and Goldfarb. They were Woody Herman's partners. They were the attorneys handling the band, and in fact if I go back and remember, it was a three way split which is pretty good for attorneys. It was 60-40 and Woody was doing all the work I feel. And about joining the band, so I said okay what does it pay, that type of thing. They said well what do you have to have? I said well send me a telegram soon. I think I said something, I didn't care to leave necessarily, Teddy Powell, because it was a good band and I was very happy. He said well how about $250, which was a lot of money. Because I remember joining Will Bradley-Ray McKinley when I was at Frank Getty's Meadowbrook with Sonny Dunham — Carlos Gastel, I finally joined the band after playing with it, and I went to Frank Getty's Meadowbrook and it was because they had two airshots a night on radio. And being there for three months would build the band. The band could go out and get booked very nice and easily then, because people would know them. And during that stint there, I heard that Will Bradley was looking for a trumpet man. And they were

rehearsing at Nola Studios in New York. And I don't quite remember how I got there on a day off or something, but Ray McKinley or someone knew that I was interested and they said well we're rehearsing at Nola's and, when you can. So I went there and I sat in and they says, "The job is yours." I think I was making about seventy dollars for the week with Sonny Dunham at the caverns or something. And it was a good band Sonny Dunham had, really, Uan Rasey was playing lead then, and he was just a kid himself. So I went to Nolas and sat in with the band, and they said well you've got the job if you want it. And I said oh, fantastic. And it was a hot band because it had the Rogers Silverware program, a half hour every week. The band was featured on the Rogers Silverware program. And I says yeah, I'd like to make it. I says I'll give two weeks notice. So I joined Will Bradley for a guarantee of ninety dollars a week, plus the radio show paid extra, I think it was thirty dollars for the half hour radio show. So that was big time supposedly. And of course after being with Will Bradley, there was Charlie Barnet, which was an episode in itself. I remember playing the theater in Harlem and Dizzy was there on the band, Al Killian, me and a good trumpet player, a short guy, Jimmy Pupa from Pittsburgh, and things like that, and George Soravo was an outside writer. He was writing charts for the band and of course you didn't have to play a pop tune to be with that band. But it was a good musician's band. And then I wonder where I went after that. That was right after Will Bradley and before going to Woody. And then in between I came back to the west coast once and Freddy Slack had a band so I hung around Los Angeles for a while and played with Freddy Slack's band and that type of thing. And then I went back out and joined Woody's band again.

MR: Yeah. Quite a trumpet section in 1946. You had Conrad—

PC: Yeah Goz came on the band after a while.

MR: Is that what you called him? You called him Goz?

PC: Yeah Gozzo. Conrad Gozzo. I called him Goz. In fact Goz was my closest friend. I'm his first child's Godfather.

MR: Oh. Now in that trumpet section, Conrad was lead? Were you the hot man? Did you split it?

PC: No, well he was a wonderful lead player, but lead had already been established with Wildroot and all the things. So he felt right at home and he played just wonderful. He played great. Marvelous sound. And it turned out just great. And we had Marky Markowitz was on the band at one time, Neal Hefti was on the band, and we had the five trumpets, let's see: Goz and I, and I can't think of who was with us at that time.

MR: Sonny Berman?

PC: Oh Sonny yeah. Neal Hefti.

MR: Even Shorty Rogers was on it for a while.

PC: Shorty was before Goz even, yeah. Yeah Shorty and Marky Markowitz, me and Sonny was on the band at that time, and Lou Irvin, somebody from Detroit for a while. Gosh.

MR: There was a lot of people. They go in and out, don't they?

PC: I remember like in '48 I remember joining Tex Benecke in the Miller band, because Goz says, "Come on the band," you know, "you've got to come on the band." So I did that. Well before that I was back on the west coast and I joined Les Brown and went the Rich's Garden was the first gig and we were there and after about a week — and he was such a wonderful guy — I said, "Look, Les, I don't think I'm going to be traveling." He said, "Well we're giving you billing as the feature, you're taking Jimmy Zito's book with the solos." I said, this was after the first Herd, I said, "I don't think I'm going to be happy, maybe you ought to get somebody else, Les, because I know what kind of music I like to play." He says, "Pete, whatever you want, but we'd sure love to have you stay."

MR: I see. Musically it wasn't something you thought you could—

PC: You know I've got to be very honest, I mean it felt like an overblown hotel band, you understand. There were five brass or three trumpets and a trombone and four sax, they had eight brass you know. But it didn't go too far above, as far as I was concerned. I was too interested in playing, and getting into things.

MR: You know when you look at the bios of the different guys in the big bands, it seems that there's about a two year period where — let me rephrase this — it seems that not often does a guy stick with a band for more than two or three years. I mean is it partly economic? Is it partly the music?

PC: Well maybe both. I would think, if they felt like me, it was principally music. Because I'd rather play for less and know that like something was happening you see. But different bands afforded a good livelihood to musicians, especially the hotel bands that stayed in one spot for six weeks. That was a long time. It seems like a lifetime, the way bands were going back and forth in those days. And I think some had kids you know, being away from kids and others wanted to continue their academic ways, and maybe wind up teaching.

MR: Sure. Because you were really young men at that time.

PC: I was just having—

MR: You were 16 when you were playing—

PC: Oh yeah, let's say when I first, well right at Purdue when I did the things with Will Bradley at the campus there, in the second year.

MR: You know I think Conte told me a story about you were playing in Chicago or something and you forgot your mouthpiece. And he had to come up and deliver it to you or something.

PC: Yeah. I think I remember that. I says I didn't have my mouthpiece. And you can't play like you play without — it's like wearing someone else's gloves or shoes, something's wrong with them. Especially when, obviously like I have no calluses on my hand so I can't play the guitar. It's about that simple. I didn't even worry about anything, to be honest with you, but I remember when I was with Tommy Dorsey at the Sherman Hotel, Hot Lips Page had a band, a small group, they played in between with Tommy and then we'd do the set and then Hot Lips Page would play. And he had a saxophone player that was playing weird. He was going for [scats] he was trying for runs, trying to make certain runs. It was fine — and the rhythm section — and it was Charlie Parker. It was Bird. Unbelievable. I said wow, that guy's going for runs. But I didn't understand. You know because to be honest with you, too —I was, technically — too young, and doing things that way. But I wasn't saying anything. What a difference.

MR: Yeah, yeah, you've got to say something.

PC: Yeah.

MR: You got the *Esquire* award — new star in 1946. That's nice.

PC: Yeah. Who voted it for me, God I forgot the band leader. I'll tell you who voted for me, "Boy Meets Horn."

MR: I'm sorry?

PC: "Boy Meets Horn" with Duke Ellington. Rex.

MR: Oh Rex Stewart.

PC: Rex Stewart, oh God bless him. What a wonderful musician he was. You know, that composition on "Boy Meets Horn." We had a lot of other things he had written, just a marvelous musician, and of course one of a kind I think.

MR: So how did — did you eventually decide, let's see, late 40s, early 50s, that the road thing was getting a little old?

PC: No it wasn't getting too old, not really. But I was into, I remember like in '43 I think it was Tommy Dorsey's band or '42 or sometime, I took Ziggy's place and I remember playing lead on an all-star Metronome date. And Sweets was there, Sweets, Harry Edison, my dear friend. We do a lot of the Blue Note things with Lionel Hampton and the Golden Men of Music, you know that. And I found an old album, and I don't have any albums, this must have been really in storage. Tommy Dorsey was playing lead trombone, I was playing lead trumpet on the date, and there was four or five trumpet players. Sweets I remember being one of them. Dud Bascomb was another.

MR: Dud Bascomb, wow.

PC: And I remember taking Cootie Williams' place with Benny Goodman at the New Yorker Hotel. I was there I think for six weeks, and Vido Musso was on the band, Hymie Schertzer was playing lead, Brad McGowan on valve trombone. It was really a good band. But I didn't care about anything. I had heard about "the ray" and things like that, how he used to think. But I remember the night before we opened up, Guy Lombardo's band was there, and I was kind of snickering a little bit because it was Muzak compared to where I was looking. But it was great for what it was. I remember going in the back room and these guys that were with Benny they come in, oh hi, hi, and some were playing cards in the band room, and some were saying, "I think you ought to pick up a hundred shares of that AT&T and things like that. They were into that, as I was a kid. You understand? But to me it didn't mean anything, because I had no idea what they were doing. But later I recognized they were into stocks and so on. I only cared about the music.

MR: I see.

PC: So it was kind of funny later on when I realized what was happening that I didn't know. It's the old story about Mark Twain saying I remember when I was 15 or 16 I remember my father just -- I was about 20, about four or five years later, I was amazed to learn how much he, my father, had learned. I was amazed how much I had learned, thinking back, what was really happening in reality.

MR: That whole experience thing again, there you go.

PC: Exactly. So finally with Woody's band I was called, they had a Teen Time Show on NBC in California. It was called a Teen Time Show. It was on television. But before that I was with Boyd Raeburn's band which was really outside. They had all real charts. We were going to open up — he had a backer for the band, Boyd did, and the band was a real outside band. George Handy was doing charts and people like that and they were going into a place called the Hurricane, which is right in Manhattan right near Nola Studios. And we were going to open up a supper club with Gertrude Nieson was the star of a show, and Boyd Raeburn was the band. And we had eight brass, Bernie Glow, Goz, me and Bernie Glow, Markie and some other trumpet. We had four rhythm and the mallet man, and the harp. In the woodwinds, we had seven woodwinds, which included bassoon, and also there was a tuba. And Ginny — not Ginny, I can't think of her name it was Boyd Raeburn's wife, she sang. But we were rehearsing, and while we were rehearsing at Nola's, like Johnny Richards was writing, a wonderful writer for orchestra, really. And I remember we were receiving a check, I think I was getting $250 a week, but we weren't doing anything because the club wasn't finished. We were just rehearsing like a couple of

charts a week for about three weeks before we finally went in. And that was an excellent band. And Buddy DeFranco was on that band. And Boots was on that band, Boots Mussulli. And Leon Cox on trombone. Wonderful facility he had. I mean Dick Nole was another trombone player. Like Goz, and I can't think Markie was there, Markowitz, and it was an excellent band. And we were there for about six weeks. And there was a man by the name of Stillman Pond, and his wife was really big in real estate, it was paying the whole payroll, which was — a backer.

MR: Yeah. That's a pretty large group to back too.

PC: Yeah. Especially in those days, the backer is like, what?

MR: Well you've racked up so many recordings, and I want to play one for you. It's a real nice sound to it.

[audio interlude]

PC: Is that Marty Paich?

MR: Possible. This is the Gerry Mulligan Tenet.

PC: Oh God, that's a long time, wow. Oh yeah, marvelous. He was really writing beautiful, wasn't he?

MR: Beautiful stuff.

PC: Oh wow. Yes, I remember now.

MR: It goes back.

PC: Of course I remember it yeah. This is while I was in Hollywood, and at that time, because I went in to lead the Teen Time Show on television. Actually I had Ronny Lang, Ted Nash was in there, a bunch of studio players now. And that was my thing before going with Peggy Lee, with Jimmy Rowles, Joe Mondragon, Jack Costanzo was on bongos, like a lover, like "When You're Near Me" and all of that. And we stayed with him for about a year, year and a half, and played places — New York, we'd be on the road for six weeks, and we did the "Black Coffee" album in New York. And then back of course. And the Teen Time Show lasted about six months. And that's when I stayed there, and that's just when I joined the staff at ABC. About '51 I think it was, and did a bunch of outside things. And then I decided I don't want to be tied down on a staff because I wanted to play more. So I did independent shows, like I did the Frank Sinatra Show, he had his own T.V. show. I guess he had just married Ava Gardner then, and then I started traveling with him for a while. Wow. I'm thinking of all these people in the wrong spots probably. But I was in California, Hollywood, you know Los Angeles.

MR: Is there a west coast jazz sound to your ears?

PC: Not really.

MR: Jazz historians say there's a west coast—

PC: If they want to say that that's fine. I think it was just players that were here on the west coast, like Shorty Rogers was really Milton Rjonski was his name, he was from New York. And he played the way he played and they want to say he's on the west coast and he's playing that way, that's fine see. But there's not really an east coast and west coast. Tiny Kahn, the drummer, wrote some great charts, east coast you know, and that whole group with Johnny Mandel and Al Cohn, all these players of that type, Bernie Glow was the trumpet player I was trying to think of, a wonderful player. But it's like trying to J.J. and Kai, you know, Winding. Kai Winding came from Washington, D.C. He came out and got more recognized in Stan Kenton's band there for a while. I wouldn't call him west coast or east coast.

MR: It's just music.

PC: To me there is no difference in sound. There is like a Latin band versus a swing band — Xavier Cugat and Duke Ellington, yeah you can tell the difference in orchestras, but not individual musicianship see, what jazz is.

MR: In all the playing you've done, did you ever have any physical problems that kind of put a crimp in your activities for a while?

PC: Only one time with Woody's band. I had a scotty that used to travel with me all the time, my little scotty. And one night I came home from the Sherman Hotel and the little scotty was asleep on the bed and I guess I awakened it and it snapped unconsciously, and bit me right on the lip. So of course it bled and swelled up a little bit, but I said well I'd better cool it and bask in the sun at least for a few days or something, which we did. But they wrote a big deal about it, like "bitten on the lip by such and such." But I used to work out all the time in Sid Klein's gym in New York and I was a health nut to be honest with you. Then at one time I think I weighed about 225 and looked about four foot high because I wore a 46 coat. I figured that was it, I was young, I was really into it. Then it dawned upon me later, a little more sensibly, like all your energy and strength is internal really, not the big bulging muscles. Those give you the energy, the strength. So I started with more repetitions with lighter weights for more definition. But it's true.

MR: You probably could have won the body building contest, at least within the musician community.

PC: I probably could have done that very easily. They put me on the cover of "Bernard."

MR: When was the first time that you got into a band that was significantly integrated?

PC: Well Woody's band. I remember when we did, they had the *Esquire* magazine, the battle of the bands with Duke Ellington, who was the year before, I think '45 was it, had won the *Down Beat* All Star Band, the pick of the band, and the following year, '45 Woody won the band, Woody's band, the Herman Herd. So we had the battle of the bands on

stage so to speak. And the narrator was Orson Welles. And then it was put on by *Esquire* magazine and I remember we were all individually introduced and then later on Woody had his own show with the Wildroot, and that's when we premiered "Ebony Concerto" by Stravinsky, he had it written for us. I'll tell you that episode sometime about Paramount Theater, what went on, rehearsing this music.

MR: I guess that was pretty difficult, right? I mean you were playing shows?

PC: Yeah it was difficult. Well I'll tell you, it was difficult to play it correctly because playing it correctly I mean playing it with a certain finesse that's required, but not hitting double D flats on the trumpet. You know I'm screaming above the band, six and eight shows a weekend at the Paramount. That is not conducive to playing delicate and with finesses. And the one part opens up with the woodwinds I guess, now this is Woody's band [scats]. Then the fugue starts in. And at one point he had [scats] on guitar. Acoustic. And Don Lamond was on the band at that time instead of Davy Tough, and he was on the brush like [scats] now not sticks, brushes. And I came in on my high C [scats].

MR: On your high C. Oh God.

PC: You know the intervals are low. And so I said oh my God, I said, with a leather lip not geared for the finesse, but I knew it had to be, and in fact he conducted us in Los Angeles for the recording that we did with Woody's band.

MR: That must have been difficult for guys who were mostly used to reading swing music, to play the stuff that he wrote.

PC: It was for certain people, like the clarinet part had a lot to be desired. I mean and guys that didn't really read or have any legitimate training, it was very tough.

MR: Chubby Jackson was on the band then?

PC: Yes. And I've got to tell you this story. We premiered with Walter Hendl, the conductor, pianist and associate conductor with the New York Philharmonic. They still have Stravinsky month at the New York Philharmonic every year. And he had Mickey Fullins playing bass clarinet, which was tom-tom [scats] one strain, and Micky Fullins and Chubby is playing arco, and he doesn't arco.

MR: He's not a bow man, right.

PC: Not at all. And he's going [scats] and Walter Hendl's going like this, like bring it up. And Chubby got so frustrated and he says, "I already got it up to seven." He stopped playing. He had to get an amplifier for his bass. He says, "I already got it up to seven" we were on the air. I'll tell you he couldn't continue the sound, I mean stunning, with laughter, it's terrible, terribly unprofessional to be honest with you. But this is the way the band — so say the bus leaves at nine, well people are straggling in at ten, and they were slow at getting to the counter. I mean think about it, you're on your own trip see? So a lot of

musicians that were good, they came to the west coast, when they said it was a nine o'clock call, it means nine o'clock downbeat. You know, you might have forty, fifty men. The clock starts going. So they had to get used to that nine o'clock means nine o'clock at Paramount downbeat. See? A whole different life.

MR: A whole different life.

PC: You don't even think about it.

MR: It must have been a bit of an adjustment.

PC: Yeah. After you say well what am I doing here. I mean if I'm doing this I must participate in what is expected. And I've done so many motion pictures with all composers, from Michel Legrand, you name them. Which, thank God, you know "Man with the Golden Arm" with Elmer Bernstein, it goes on and on, especially with Hank, all the things we've done, Mancini you know. I really hadn't thought about this in a long time to be honest with you.

MR: How many years did you put into the studio?

PC: When I went into the studio I was doing a minimum of six half hours shows a week with Earle Hagen, Herbie Spencer, who, God bless, a wonderful guy, used to orchestrate for Kostelanetz years ago in New York, and in fact he was doing a lot for John Williams, that's a whole different story I'll bring in, I lived next to his folks, before he came into town, a great piano player John is really, more so than anything else. Sometime we'll go into it. But at that time like I guess from Alfred Newman to Hugo Friedhofer to you name them, I've done so much. George Dunning, "Bell Book and Candle," things Conte and I did with a small group within a Broadway play. I think of them it's pretty funny. It's like the first time doing "Peter Gunn" with Hank Mancini, so uncertain once it would be picked up, Blake Edwards was the producer, that have a shot, that all that skyrocketed, and he gave the first single to Ray Anthony, was a friend that he had written form, he said if you'll guarantee me you'll put it out as a single, I'll make sure there's another one with a single on it, on the theme of "Peter Gunn."

MR: To Ray Anthony?

PC: Yeah. And of course Ray Anthony could do what he wanted, he had a contract with Capitol, but I mean he did it for Hank and of course you know the rest. And Hank only had the album out on RCA Victor, but not the single. There were things like indescript things like "Mom's Place" where there's an off-the-road type cafe and bar where Peter Gunn used to hang out. And they were thinking how about Shorty Rogers, he's with RCA Victor and he has a contract there, and why not do something like "Shorty Rogers at Mom's Place." And Hank said no, it's my music, I want to do it, if you want my music.

And that was it, the rest is history. He was a wonderful orchestrator and a composer Hank is, or was.

MR: Did he mostly do his own orchestrating?

PC: Oh yeah. Wonderful orchestrating. He had all the tools, oh yeah, marvelous. And it's like John Williams, a wonderful orchestrator, you know when he wanted Richard Strauss, pull out the file and — or like anybody.

MR: Do you have any recollections of days in the studio when you really were hurting for one reason or another? You really didn't have it, and it was a struggle for you to get through a cue or something?

PC: I don't know. I really don't know, because it's a habit. You see when you're considered a top studio player, your facilities, whatever it is, legitimately — you ever hear of "One Night Jacks" by Hugo Friedhofer, that's a Marlon Brando picture?

MR: Yes.

PC: What an orchestrator. I mean he is such a good composer that you don't need a time, a clock to catch a cue. If you played naturally, like it's written, it falls, that's it. He's just one of those people. And anybody that writes like this, they don't use a C trumpet instead of a B flat trumpet, and write like it's a B flat trumpet. There's a difference in quality between the C. See it has a different edge, a different pitch. Good composers will know that and use it and write in the right register for that so it gets that sound. Things like this. Writing for, okay that's a trumpet, it's a trumpet. And these things become a matter of habit. The longer I was here, I've done so many of it, so many composers, like Michel, who'd rather sing and play piano instead of write. And he sounds terrible when he sings. I mean I love him, you know, but I remember he studied with Madame Boulanger, a French lady who used to teach composition and a lot of people have studied with her. But of all of the people who studied with her — Roy Harris, my composition teacher — he studied with her. He was a composer when he was 27. And good. And he says I've had some drawn out fights with her to prove her wrong. He says give me two weeks and I'll assure you, you're wrong, you know, musically that is. I mean there are some things that come out that are just unbelievable. And he said the person that showed Igor Stravinsky orchestration was a Frenchman, not the Russian that they say he studied with, no it was a Frenchman that taught him orchestration.

MR: Judy Garland, Ella Fitzgerald, Peggy Lee, wow. How long do we have here, right? But now—

PC: Just let me, I'm talking too much.

MR: No, what kind of things stick out in your mind with some of these stars? Are they great to work with the majority of them?

PC: Yeah, yeah they are. Usually the more they've done, the less frightened they are, and the nicer they are you see? And Frank Sinatra, I played trumpet with Frank for about four or five years. And Frank's pilots flew me into Vegas many times, at least six or seven times I can think of, because of the one show at ten o'clock, and I finished "The Carol Burnett Show" like about eight thirty or quarter of nine or nine o'clock and I'd try to rush out, they'd have a car for me, and go to Burbank, and they'd take off and I'd be there for the downbeat.

MR: In Las Vegas?

PC: Yeah.

MR: That's wild.

PC: And always, Frank was really great. I was there when the guy pulled the gun on him. There was a big scene that happened. We were all sitting around—

MR: I'm not familiar with that.

PC: Well somebody had pulled a gun on him, had a gripe for one of the other owners of the places or something, when he drove a golf cart into the pool years before or something. And everybody was sitting there and this older guys comes and says, "How dare you, who do you think you—" and he pulled out a gun and the officers were right there around Frank you know, like it happened like this. And he said, "Okay fellas, that's it, it's a wrap." He had one more show, that's when we'd do two shows a night at Caesar's. He said, "It's a wrap, let's go." That was it. We had about another week and a half I think. Oh many incidents happened but I'm sure you're more interested in the music aspect or how the lives, the things that musicians go through, it can be so difficult you know.

MR: You remained pretty healthy. Not so with some of the musicians.

PC: You know there was a time when dissipation was the thing, unfortunately, you know the drug scene or getting strung out. Well it's like when people used to booze, you know, liked to take drinks. Later on, I'm talking about 45, 50 years ago, nobody thought anything about drinking. But then they found out about this thing called alcoholism, you know, and then later, Alcoholics Anonymous and things like that, because it's a real sickness in a sense. You know if it's in the genes prior, that it can be very — and I used to know guys that used to have a few drinks before they can play. And that's too bad because I don't know why, nice guys, nice as you are. One of my closest friends, Jimmy Rowles, was an alcoholic and we traveled with Peggy and finally the doctor says hey, "I don't want to be your doctor, I don't want to be responsible." And God bless him, such a beautiful guy, and such a monster musically speaking. Other people like that, friends, I go on talking about them, I mean wonderful people, wonderful guys. And they gave me so much inspiration and really I've been a very lucky guy.

MR: What has your experience been overseas?

PC: Fine. The reception of course, they know more about an artist over there then they do here in the States. It's like one time I went over with Benny Carter, with different players, you know Frank Wess and really some wonderful players. And had about maybe ten, twelve concerts, and we landed at Narita airport, and there's white sheets from a bed, king size probably, all strung together "Welcome Pete Candoli and Blackwell and Benny Carter, all the guy's names and we got all the people applauding, fans, they know who played third trumpet on one tune and who played lead, who took the solo?

MR: This is in Japan?

PC: In Japan. And they know this, they make a study of this, to them it's history, and they know every artist, where it was recorded, the year, afternoon date or evening date, and right away they take you in stretch limos, Cadillacs, about six or seven of them take us to one of the major hotels, for all the press, while we're being checked in by the management and we're they with hors d'oeuvres and talking and they're shooting pictures, just like you'd think the Rolling Stones came to town. And even in Europe, that's how they acknowledge the players. They know who you are.

MR: What's your playing routine these days?

PC: Well Conte and I have been doing very well together as The Brothers, in fact we've got a CD coming out and we were both fortunate to be inducted in the National Jazz Hall of Fame which was nice, with some good company. Nat Cole's wife was there posthumously picking up a trophy for him and a lot of people, Chet Baker, that had been inducted. And that's done a lot for us as The Brothers – we're finally coming out with, we've done it already, it will be released by Hindsight Records, they just released an album done by SuperSax in Japan, they got a hold of that. They pulled out choice things I think. They're very particular who they release. So that plus the concerts we're doing, we'll be going to, not Phoenix, Scottsdale, that's where the next one is being held in May, the new winners to be inducted in the Jazz Hall of Fame, and it's a three day affair, black tie type of thing. I think Clint Eastwood was going to emcee one of them, I don't know, maybe this one. And so that's one thing. Then we're doing different colleges which we do — we've done Lionel Hampton's School of Music three or four times together. We're not doing it this February. We'll be doing a ship, we're booked on a ship for six days which we'll take our own rhythm section, Conte and I, and then we're playing some college, Imperial College, right near the border, east of San Diego, and we'll be doing a one night concert there, and I think Conte and I will give a seminar to the music department.

MR: You seem to have played right through the rock & roll revolution, intact.

PC: Very lucky. I think that's when I did most of the work in the studio, then branched out for a hit and a miss every now and then, and then we were very lucky with Alabama and Chicago, they asked us to dub on like several years ago, if we could overdub some things.

MR: Alabama?

PC: Yeah.

MR: And Chicago.

PC: And Chicago, yeah. We had many other groups, you know they liked the sound of something acoustic for a change of course, which was great. There are some good musicians, really marvelous players, but so much heavy garbage thrown in. It's like jazz sometimes, you know, you can hear it all the time or blues, or what you call jazz, there's the fine or good things you want to pick out, that are memorable, academically speaking, memorable, good interpretation for a jazz type of thing. And then there's a lot of filler.

MR: Yeah, a lot of filler. That's a good usable word.

PC: And God bless, everybody can do something. I don't care what field you're in, if it's country western, be the best it can, that's my kind of philosophy. I don't put anything down like that. That's it. And their taste, and what they like, is as valid as mine. I'm just another person. Hopefully they would respect me the same with my taste, I don't know. But I'm talking so much really—

MR: That's why you're here.

PC: I know, I mean please—

MR: No, it's amazing when you think that you could be riding down the street and be listening to something old or fairly new and you probably think, you know I think I played on that.

PC: Yeah. Somebody, a guy who puts out a little music magazine about trumpets or something, Ulderis is his name, and he showed me some albums and records and things this from the motion picture so and so, your solos. I don't even remember them. Honest I don't. But it's okay. Not that they haven't been worthwhile—

MR: Right. Well it's almost like I guess when asking an accountant, do you remember when you went do to work on January 4th 1960—

PC: And put down $7.95 for something.

MR: Yeah, right.

PC: Just about, in a sense, yeah.

MR: But the degree of professionalism you've been able to keep over the years, I have to commend you for that.

PC: I know. Well thank you. I've been very lucky. I've been in the right places. I know some players that just are marvelous, some of these stage bands, really. I remember Al Vizzutti, you know Vizzutti?

MR: Al Vizzutti? Yeah.

PC: What a wonderful guy and what a tremendous player, really, wonderful. And at one time I tried to play a place called El Chapultepec every year in Denver. It's called the El Chapultepec, which is a grasshopper. And the guy who runs it is Jerry Krantz. No cover, no minimum, and he takes care of artists financially and every other way. And I said, "You know there's a guy by the name of Alan Vizzutti, he's just phenomenal." He said, "Yeah I know." I said, "Well you ought to bring him in." He said, "Well you know, Pete, I've got to have some people that people know." See I've been around since— And I said, "Well they'll know him once he's here, I mean you'll have him back." He said, "Oh, okay, I'll think about it if there's a slow thing or something." It's hard to get people. Then he said, "Well how do you get a record date, or how do you get your own recording?" I said there's no real rule.

MR: Nowadays people pay for it themselves.

PC: Yeah. Either that or a special deal of some kind or something. And you know now we did, with the Metropole Orchestra, we opened up the Trumpet Guild, I think it was the fifth Trumpet Guild or Brass Trumpet Guild they call it, in Holland. And in there they had trumpet players from South America, Maurice Andre of France that performed with the Philharmonic, and I got to meet Timofei Dokshizer, the great Russian trumpet player. And it was Chuck Findley and Bob Findley, brothers, and Conte and I, we went over there with the Metropole, to rehearse with the Metropole Orchestra, and Rob Pronk, its conductor, and they wrote charts and we talked, corresponded. We did "Doodlin'", Conte and I did "Doodlin'" and a couple of other things together. He did four of his own and I did four, and the same with the Findleys, Chuck and Bob. And the orchestra, you turned your head and they had a Basie thing in the brasses, it would just scare you. Now it's backed by the government. No real relation, you understand, but we knew it. And meeting Dokshizer, he called us in Rotterdam the opening night after two weeks they have in Alba. We talked under Dorwin Handy, the interpreter, and he said he loves jazz, loves jazz. I did "Boy Meets Horn" with 85 men you know, things like that, and it turned out wonderful. And he did, I saw a tape of what he did with the Philharmonic, and he and Maurice Andre, he did piccolo trumpet and not just on the trumpet, he has since come here two or three times just the most marvelous guy you ever want to meet in your life. He said, "I was better when I was younger," he said. And I couldn't believe that sound. It was unbelievable.

MR: Wow. Well this has been really quite fascinating.

PC: Well it has been for me. I'm recalling things I forgot. I'm sorry.

MR: Well when we do Part Two down the line, we'll make up for it—

PC: Oh anytime Monk, I hope it helps the archives.

MR: I'm sure it will.

PC: I hope so. I told Conte I was going to be seeing you.

MR: Oh good.

PC: He said to say hello.

MR: Yeah. Well thanks for your time, and I wish you continued success with all your future adventures.

PC: Anytime I can be of any help—

MR: Can you imagine if some day if someone showed up at your house with every record you ever played on?

PC: No. No I couldn't.

MR: You'd have to have a whole—

PC: Because I don't remember.

MR: Yeah, that's be wild.

PC: Gosh I'm still active and in good health, so I'm thankful for everything, really.

MR: All right, thanks for your time.

PC: Thanks Monk, thank you so much, and the school, thank you.